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APAC Industrial & Auto Sector Specialist Sales Commentary
Auto & EV • Equipment • Machinery • E&C • A&D

CH Auto Update on EU Policy, KR Defense; Rotem Preview, CATL Preview, EU Cap Good Feedback

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SPX (-1.1%) fell on Friday, bringing its weekly decline to c.2%—the worst week since early June—as the tech selloff resumed. Treasuries were mixed with the long end slightly higher, while Fed Chair Warsh remained non-committal on the timing of further tightening. Oil also moved higher as Ukraine renewed attacks on Russian refineries and uncertainty persisted around shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. Looking ahead, earnings broaden this week with GE Aerospace, GM, 3M, RTX, Northrop Grumman, and Netflix on Tuesday; Meta, Tesla, IBM, and Texas Instruments on Wednesday; and Union Pacific on Thursday. Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's GTC Berlin keynote will also be in focus, while the Fed enters its blackout period on Sat ahead of the October FOMC meeting. JPM APAC pad this morning starting the day as better to buy on light volumes; led by passive inflows into Japan & marginal buyers of KR/TW semis.

EU leaders agreed to implement a hard annual import quota on HEV/PHEV into the EU (VER framework) with a ceiling of 350k units/year, effective Dec 1, 2026 for 4 years, with +6% annual expansion from year 2. This is largely in-line with what investors expected. Nick Lai remains bearish on China Auto into 2027E with combined policy impacts (EU quota + China's Apr-2027 NEV export VAT rebate cut 13%→9%), our sensitivity suggests 2027 earnings hit of ~12–15% for BYD (implied ~16x FY27E P/E), ~10–12% for Chery (implied ~6x), and ~6–9% for Leapmotor (implied ~10x).

KR Sep defense exports were US$1.4bn (+74% q/q), led by land systems, with Hanwha Aerospace shipping 22/10 K9 SPHs to Poland/Romania (~80% of its FY Poland guide after only 9 units in Jan–Aug), Hyundai Rotem delivering another 6 K2 tanks to Poland (now ~1/3 of the 180-unit EC2 contract in four months), and KAI exporting ~US$54m of fighter jets to the Philippines (FA-50). Strong September delivery should ease investors' concerns over 4Q earnings visibility concerns; We view 3Q earnings noise as not indicative of execution risk and stay positive on the sector—Hanwha Aerospace remains our top pick (also like LIG D&A; Neutral Hyundai Rotem/KAI).

CATL is reporting tomorrow after market close; 8pm HKT earnings call. JPM is providing SI Eng translation of the call w/ Rebeca Wen hosting CATL 3Q26 review call on Oct 20 (430pm HKT for Mandarin Session/ 8pm HKT , 1pm UK, 8m NY for Eng session). Rebecca Wen forecasts CATL 3Q26 sales volume of 260–265GWh (+55–60% y/y) and NP of ~RMB24.5bn. Noting buyside consensus has been moving down to RMB23–24bn (closer to RMB23bn), ~250GWh sales volume, and a mild decline in unit profit q/q.

- **CH Auto Industry:** EU Policy Move Part 2: Annual Volume Cap on Chinese HEV/PHEV - Nick Lai
- **KR Defense:** September Defense exports show meaningful rebound; Hanwha Aero ships 22/10 units of K9 to Poland/ Romania - Simon Han
- **CATL (3000750 CH) 3Q Preview:** Reporting Tomorrow (Oct 20) - Earnings Briefing at 8pm HKT
- **Global X-across: European Cap Good -** US Marketing Feedback; Sentiment felt like it did back in 2028, names uncorrelated to AI in focus - Phil Buller

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Sector Key Newsflow
Full Research Links
Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Industrials Events

Catalyst Calendar (Full Version)

Detailed Highlights

China Auto Industry: EU Policy Move Part 2: Annual Volume Cap on Chinese HEV/PHEV - Nick Lai

- **EU leaders agreed to implement a hard annual import quota on HEV/PHEV into the EU (VER framework) with a ceiling of 350k units/year, effective Dec 1, 2026 for 4 years, with +6% annual expansion from year 2**; anything above the cap would be physically blocked at EU ports.
- **The EU plans to enforce this via a WTO safeguard mechanism** (formally non-discriminatory/global in design), i**mplying the quota pool is shared across exporters (incl. China/Korea/Japan)**, while China should not receive less favorable treatment; Chinese-brand vehicles assembled in the EU are exempt. Anti-circumvention clauses imply exports routed via third-country assembly (e.g., Thailand/Brazil) may still be treated as China-origin and/or counted toward China's cap.
- **On combined policy impacts** (EU quota + China's Apr-2027 NEV export VAT rebate cut 13%→9%), **our sensitivity** suggests 2027 earnings hit of ~12–15% for BYD (implied ~16x FY27E P/E), ~10–12% for Chery (implied ~6x), and ~6–9% for Leapmotor (implied ~10x).
- **We remain cautious on China autos into 2027;** prefer Sinotruk (HDT), Chery Auto (high FCF yield/high cash), and longer-dated consolidation beneficiary Guangzhou Auto.
- **Other Asian OEMs Implication:** While a ~350k unit annual sales quota has been discussed for China OEMs (with other countries expected to have their own quotas; details not yet out), Kishimoto-san flags potential downside for Mazda and Mitsubishi Motors if quotas are also applied to Japanese OEMs. Mazda exports the CX-60 and CX-80 PHEVs from Japan, and Mitsubishi exports the Outlander PHEV. For Korea, Sonny Lee flags ~50% of hybrid/PHEVs are locally produced, out of ~200k units sold in the EU annually.
- **Investor Feedback & Sales View:** Investors generally remain cautious on CH Auto overall, but are reluctant to add more shorts given high outstanding short interest and elevated days to cover, while most key headline risks are now known. Investors are actively discussing what near-term catalysts could trigger short covering. While 3Q earnings are expected to be a non-event, some investors see a chance of sales volume front-loading in 4Q/1Q ahead of the EU import quota and the NEV export VAT rebate cut, which could drive a volume uptick and trigger some short covering. As a result, we are hearing some investors cover shorts on weakness and wait for the right time to press shorts again. The most inbounds are on Sinotruck (an HDT name with an export share-gain story, not in scope of the policy changes) on the long side, while Chery is discussed on the short side for tactical reasons (lower outstanding shorts and lock-up expiry risk, while still in scope of the policy changes despite local production and having the relatively best positioning among PVs).

Korea Defense: September Defense exports show meaningful rebound; Hanwha Aero ships 22/10 units of K9 to Poland/ Romania - Simon Han

- **Korea's Sep defense exports were US$1.4bn (+74% q/q), led by land systems**.
- **Key Notables: Hanwha Aerospace** shipped 22/10 K9 SPHs to Poland/Romania (vs 9 units total in Jan–Aug), reaching ~80% of its FY Poland guide (30 units) and easing 4Q delivery concerns; **Hyundai Rotem** shipped another 6 K2 tanks to Poland (28/18/6 in Jun/Jul/Aug), completing ~1/3 of the 180-unit EC2 contract in four months; **KAI** exported ~US$54m of fighter jets to the Philippines (consistent with FA-50 orders). YTD exports are US$11.5bn (vs US$11.2bn in 2025) with destinations broadening beyond Poland (EU/MENA/ASEAN).
- **We view 3Q earnings noise as not indicative of execution risk and stay positive on the sector**—Hanwha Aerospace remains our top pick (also like LIG D&A; Neutral Hyundai Rotem/KAI).
- Hyundai Rotem **Reporting today (1:10pm HKT Earnings Call):** Simon Han forecasts 3Q OP W257bn (~8% below Cons of W278.9bn & Buyside Cons of ~W250bn) mainly on FX; assume q/q flat defense export OPM with cost writebacks from first K2 Poland deliveries offset by FX. Key to watch: Order visibility on Poland EC3 & Peru order timing. W/limited new order updates we see downside risk to street 27E OP.
- **Investor Feedback:** KR defense names were up last Friday on the market rebound and strong Sep export data for Hanwha Aerospace. Hanwha Aero is still expected to miss 3Q26 earnings given the absence of Poland exports and FX headwinds. The company exported 30+ units of K9 in Sep vs only 2 units delivered during 3Q26 (vs annual guidance of 30+ units this year), raising investor concern that the earnings miss/cut cycle could extend into 4Q26. Investor feedback on Hanwha Aero improved on the Sep export data, with investors having better earnings confidence into 4Q26 on expectations for Saudi order

finalization sometime in 4Q26 (~W15tr). In contrast, investor feedback on LIG D&A has become mixed, with concerns on 2H26 margins due to increasing R&D costs into 2H26 (full-year OPM guidance at 8% vs 1H26 OPM at ~9%). That said, investors remain mid-term constructive on rising ME export momentum and higher global defense spending allocation favoring missiles/drones, while staying near-term cautious into 2H26.

CATL (3000750 CH) 3Q Preview: Reporting Tomorrow (Oct 20) - Earnings Briefing at 8pm HKT

- **3Q26 JPMe vs Buyside Cons**: Rebecca Wen forecasts 3Q26 net profit of RMB 24.5bn & 265Gw production. Buyside consensus: RMB 23-24bn (clower to the lower end as we head towards earnings) with ~250+GW production expecting a mild decline in unit proit QoQ. Rebecca Wen's latest on CH battery sector
- **Investor Feedback**: Despite elevated outstanding short balance and high days to cover, we note investor sentiment on CATL remains bearish (especially CATL-H given the lack of fund flow support), and we are seeing growing interest in playing A–H discount narrowing. Fundamentally, investors think most negatives are in the price with some valuation support, but are closely watching China domestic lithium carbonate pricing as a key leading indicator of industry demand sentiment (which has corrected sharply over the past week). Investors are also focused on management's 2027 outlook on tomorrow's conference call and the unit profit trend, which has been mildly declining.
- **JPM is providing Eng SI translation to its earnings call:** Self-registration link – click here.

Table 5: CATL's unit profit trend: GP, NP and OPCF

Unit profit (Rmb/wh)	2022	2023	2024	2025	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26
Gross profit – company level	0.20	0.20	0.19	0.17	0.17	0.16	0.16	0.18	0.16	0.15
Core operating profit	0.11	0.12	0.11	0.11	0.09	0.10	0.10	0.12	0.11	0.10
Reported net profit	0.11	0.11	0.11	0.11	0.11	0.11	0.11	0.10	0.10	0.10
Net profit excluding non-recurring items	0.10	0.10	0.09	0.10	0.09	0.10	0.10	0.09	0.09	0.09
Operating cashflow per unit	0.21	0.24	0.20	0.20	0.26	0.17	0.13	0.24	0.17	0.11

Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates. Gross Profits are post accounting changes.

Global X-across: European Cap Good - US Marketing Feedback; Sentiment felt like it did back in 2028, names uncorrelated to AI in focus - Phil Buller

- **Phil was in the US marketing last week: Sentiment was bearish/low-conviction (Oct-2018-like) amid fast-moving bond markets, election/geopolitics uncertainty and debate on AI capex sustainability beyond 2028**. We still prefer Europe vs the US on valuation and cycle—EU Industrials trade ~18x at ~25% discount to US peers despite mid-teens growth, with AI buildout earlier in EMEA/APAC and EU PMIs catching up. **Within electricals, interest was selective:** Schneider Electric (Neutral) is widely seen as oversold on the PTC deal, and Siemens Energy (OW, AFL) screens "too cheap" but volatility keeps many sidelined into the Nov CMD; Legrand's CMD wasn't enough to re-engage US LOs. **Incremental interest skewed to idiosyncratic/non-electrical ideas** (Kone OW on TKE optionality; mining downstream FLSmidth/Weir; Epiroc well-owned as copper beta), while Sandvik (Neutral) remains held back by tungsten risk; UK LOs showed interest in Halma/ Spirax on valuation.
- **Read Phil Buller on Schneider Electric:** Post Call Thoughts - SE Asia DC growth a sustainble source of growth, PTC financing questions remain
- **Investor Feedback on Asia Names:** Mixed -investors generally prefer Japan names (Hitachi) over KR/China players. Hitachi now appears a consensus long in the space, with expectations for an upward revision to mid-term Energy division margin guidance into its Energy IR Day on Nov 4, alongside positive sentiment on domestic DSS on rising cybersecurity needs. MELCO remains a funding short for now, but we are starting to hear sentiment improving into 2027 on expectations of 800V-driven orders, potential restructuring of the Auto equipment division as a catalyst, and stable earnings supported by domestic infrastructure-related business. In contrast, investors remain bearish on KR power equipment given the lack of a service-related business to support the long-term earnings story and concerns that order growth has peaked, driving de-rating risk,

though investors acknowledge ~15x 27E P/E could be near-term share price support.

- **News: MELCO (6503**) – Co will sell 50% of its auto parts unit to Foxconn for Y115bn, forming a 50:50 JV focused on EV and autonomous driving technologies, Nikkei.

Sector Key Newsflow

- **Geely Holding:** Q1–Q3 sales reached a record 3.00mn vehicles; NEV sales increased 12.6% YoY to 1.79mn, lifting NEV penetration to 59.7%, while Zeekr deliveries rose 101% to 288,404 vehicles. (Gasgoo)
- **Xpeng:** Expanded GX shipments overseas as Middle East orders exceeded 3,000 units; September overseas sales surpassed 10,000 vehicles for the first time. (CnEVPost)
- **China auto policy:** China's MIIT released an AI- n roadmap spanning more than 1,000 scenarios across 20 industries, including AI-led vehicle design, flexible production lines, quality control, predictive maintenance and vehicle-road-cloud integration. (Gasgoo)
- **MHI (7011)** – Co will restart a dormant shipbuilding line in 2027 to boost naval vessel capacity after export rules eased and defense demand surged, Nikkei.
- **HITACHI (6501)** – Hitachi Energy will invest ~Y53bn in a new transformer insulation plant in Canada to meet rising power demand from AI data centers, Nikkei.
- **MELCO (6503**) – Co will sell 50% of its auto parts unit to Foxconn for Y115bn, forming a 50:50 JV focused on EV and autonomous driving technologies, Nikkei.
- **KIA MOTOR(000270)(*):**Kia is expanding its presence in the defense market, driven by a surge in domestic military vehicle demand and a 52.5% YoY increase in special vehicle sales to 5,484 units through September. The outlook is for further growth as Korea's military modernization accelerates and Kia leverages domestic performance to pursue global exports, including new contracts in Poland and ongoing efforts to supply next-generation vehicles abroad.
- **HYUNDAI MOTOR GROUP(*):** Hyundai Motor and Kia plan to fully automate new factories by 2032, leveraging robotics, AI agents, and digital twin technology to drive manufacturing transformation. The outlook is for accelerated adoption of software-centric production platforms, with Nvidia's digital twin and Hyundai's proprietary AI agent "Polaris" enabling real-time simulation, quality control, and operational efficiency. Key automation technologies will be rolled out sequentially.

Full Research Links

Company Note:

- **Subaru (7207 JP)**: Development strategy briefing and research and experiment center tour: Increasing profitability of lineup expansion - Akira Kishimoto (Link)
- **Central Japan Railway & West Japan Railway:** Fare hikes: A somewhat earlier-than-expected timing leaves a favorable impression- Ryota Himeno (Link)
- **Tesla Inc (TSLA US):**Next-Gen Roadster Gets a (Largely Anticipated) Rocket Upgrade, Showcasing Deep SPCX Collaboration; Expected SoP in 2028- Rajat Gupta (Link)
- **Schneider Electric (SU FP):**Post Call Thoughts - SE Asia DC growth a sustainable source of growth, PTC financing questions remain - Phil Buller (Link)
- **Schneider Electric (SU FP):**Q3'26 Sales - First Take - Triple-digit DC growth drives strong Q3, FY guidance upgrade largely in line with consensus - Phil Buller (Link)

Sector Note:

- **China Auto:** EU Policy move Part 2: Annual volume cap on Chinese HEV/PHEV - Nick Lai (Link)
- **Korea Defense:** What's new in Korea defense? Narrative only strengthening; Chunmoo & air defense weapons still in high demand- Simon Han (Link)
- **Korea Defense:**September defense exports show meaningful rebound; Hanwha Aero ships 22/10 units of K9 to Poland/ Romania- Simon Han (Link)
- **Korea Utilities and Nuclear EPC:** Korea nuclear update: Polish nuclear project proceeds; eyeing on the SMR catalysts from

US/Europe- Sonny Lee (Link)

- **Clean Energy & Power Infrastructure:** Checking the Pulse on Power: Takeaways from JPM Buyside Sentiment Survey- Mark Strouse (Link)
- **JPM/US Auto Ecosystem - CVNA and KMX September Loan Performance Update:** Rajat Gupta
- **Global Autos Driver:**Global Autos Newsflow & Research- Jose M Asumendi (Link)
- **JPM Autos Tracker:**Global Light Vehicle Production: Quarterly Outlook Revisions: Europe/ China/ NA Downward in Q4- Jose M Asumendi (Link)
- **JPM Autos Tracker: September China wholesale PCs update:** Wholesale PCs post-seasonal +8.6% MoM gain, still -9.5% YoY & -5.9% YTD, big German OEMs show continued softness- Jose M Asumendi (Link)

Save the Dates: J.P. Morgan Industrials Events

Analyst Meetings & JPM Webinars

Title	Speaker / Sector Coverage	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Sonny Lee	Korea Auto, Robotics, Battery and Utility	Singapore; Hong Kong	Oct-19-20 (Mon-Tue); 21-23 (Wed-Fri)	Please Ask
Akira Kishimoto + Nick Lai + Sonny Lee Group Lunch	APAC Autos	Singapore	Oct-20 (Tue) 12:00 HKT	Please Ask
Karen Li & Jenny Qiu	Asia Infrastructure, Industrial & Transport	KL; Singapore	Nov-3 (Tue); 4-6 (Wed-Fri)	Please Ask

Corporate Access

Title	Speaker	Format	Date/Time (HKT)	Registration
Fuyao Glass (3606 HK)	IR	Virtual	Oct-21 (Wed) 15:00 HKT	Register Here
Pultegroup Inc (PHM US)	IR	Virtual	Oct-23 (Fri) 6:00 HKT	Register Here
Magna International Inc (MGA US)	IR	Virtual	Nov-3 (Tue) 9:00 HKT	Register Here
Boustead Singapore (BOCS SP)	Deputy Group CEO, Head of Corp Marketing & IR	Virtual	Nov-12 (Thu) 10::00 AM	Register Here
Caterpillar Inc. (CAT US)	IR	Virtual	Nov-24 (Tue) 8:30 HKT	Register Here
Southwest Airlines Co (LUV US)	Head of IR	Virtual	Dec-1 (Tue) 9:00 HKT	Register Here

Conferences & Tours

Title	Format	Date/Time (HKT)
Japan Markets Forum (Save the date)	Four Seasons Hotel Tokyo Otemachi	Dec-01 (Tue)
Thailand Forum	Bangkok	Jan-21-22 (Thu-Fri)

Doko Shuzai (JPM Analyst-led coverage company meetings)

Date	Time	Language	Company	Host	Location	Registration
Wed 28 Oct	14:15-15:15 JST	J	CANON INC (7751 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	13:00-14:00 JST	J / E	MITSUB ELEC CORP (6503 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	14:30-15:30 JST	J / E	HITACHI LTD (6501 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 02 Nov	16:00-17:00 JST	J	NEC CORP (6701 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Wed 04 Nov	11:00-12:00 JST	J / E	PANASONIC HOLDIN (6752 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Wed 04 Nov	15:00-16:00 JST	J	FUJITSU LTD (6702 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click
Mon 09 Nov	11:00-12:15 JST	J	YAMAHA CORP (7951 JP)	Junya Ayada	Zoom	Click

Catalyst Calendar (Full Version, all in HKT)

Date	A&D	Autos & EVs	E&C	Electric & Industrial Equipments	Machinery	Macro
10/19	Rotem Q3	SHANGHAI PUTAI-A Q3	Jushi Q3			CH - Used Home Prices (09:30) CH - Industrial Production (10:00)
10/20	GENERAL ELECTRIC Q3 (Aft-mkt) NORTHROP GRUMMAN Q3 (Aft-mkt) RTX CORP Q3 (Aft-mkt)	Gotion High-Tech EGM (15:00) Fuyao Glass- H Q3 CATL Q3 GENERAL MOTORS C Q3 (18:30) MICHELIN Q3 Sales (23:45)		ABB LTD-REG Q3 (13:00)		
10/21			Fletcher building AGM (05:30) China State Construction Q3	CENTRE TESTING-A Q3		SK - Exports 20 Days (08:00)
10/22	THALES SA Q3 Sales (13:00) LOCKHEED MARTIN Q3 (Aft-mkt) CARPENTER TECH Q1 (Aft-mkt)	TESLA INC Q3 (Bef-mkt) VISTEON CORP Q3 (Aft-mkt) VALEO Q3 Sales (Bef-mkt)	SCHINDLER HLD-PC Q3 (Aft-mkt)	HAN'S LASER -A Q3 Jinghai Capacitor Q3 UNITED RENTALS Q3 (Bef-mkt) REXEL SA Q3 Sales	METSO CORP Q3 (Aft-mkt) SANDVIK AB Q3 (14:00) ATLAS COPCO-A Q3 (18:00)	JN - Machine Tool Orders (14:00)
10/23	SAAB AB-B Q3 (13:30)	EVE Energy Q3 VOLVO AB-B Q3 (13:20) AUTOLIV INC Q3 (18:00)	SIGNIFY NV Q3 (Aft-mkt) ELECTROLUX AB-B Q3 (13:00)	Reliance Worldwide Corp AGM (07:00) FANUC CORP H1 (14:30) Sieyuan Electric Q3 CG Power Q2		IN - HSBC India PMI Mfg (13:00) TA - Industrial Production (16:00) EC - HCOB Eurozone Manufacturing PMI (16:00) US - S&P Global US Manufacturing PMI (21:45)

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